Juan-Andrés Castro

✉ j.castrocienfuegos@qmul.ac.uk juanandrescastro.com

Placement Director: Professor Marco Manacorda
m.manacorda@qmul.ac.uk

Fields

Primary: Development Economics, Organizational Economics, Public Economics
Secondary: Technology Adoption, Firm Dynamics, Digital Infrastructure

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Queen Mary University of London — Expected June 2027
Supervisors: Pedro Souza and Lucie Gadenne
MRes in Economics, Queen Mary University of London — 2023
M.Sc. in Economics, University of Chile — 2018
B.Sc. in Economics, University of Chile — 2016

References

Dr Pedro Souza
Queen Mary University of London
p.souza@qmul.ac.uk

Dr Lucie Gadenne
Queen Mary University of London
l.gadenne@qmul.ac.uk

Professor Jonas Hjort
University College London
j.hjort@ucl.ac.uk

Professor Felipe González
King's College London
felipe.gonzalez@kcl.ac.uk

Job Market Paper

"Less Paper, More Public Service: Communication Technology inside the State"

Abstract: Public services often leave capacity unused while demand goes unmet. These gaps can persist because the decisions that would close them require information to travel between state entities, often as paper documents. I exploit the staggered rollout of a digital platform in Chile that replaced paper in official communication between state entities. Within the national public childcare agency, adoption cuts document processing times by 70%, and documents from the departments that coordinate enrollment rise, concentrated in the months when seats are assigned. Enrollment at the agency's centers rises by 11%, with no increase in capacity, and no detectable change in applications per eligible child or at providers outside the reform. The increase is concentrated in centers whose enrollment relies more on these documents. The pattern is consistent with better communication between state entities raising public output.

Working Papers

"Market Power, Ownership Concentration and Income Inequality" with Alejandro Micco, Andrea Repetto, and Patricio Toro, 2026

Abstract: We quantify the distributional effects of market power by decomposing capital income into competitive returns and market-power rents and assigning these components to ultimate individual owners. Using matched firm-level and taxpayer-level administrative data for Chile from 2008 to 2016, we estimate firm-level markups and trace monopoly rents through ownership networks. Capital income is highly concentrated, but competitive returns are more skewed than market-power rents because very large firms exhibit lower markups. As a result, market-power rents account for a smaller share of income at the very top of the distribution. Inequality decompositions imply that reductions in market power lower inequality despite increases in competitive returns, as the associated rise in the labor share dominates. Our results provide new empirical evidence on how ownership structure mediates the link between market power and inequality.

"Financial Constraints and Firm Adjustments During a Sales Disruption" with Enzo Cerletti. Central Bank of Chile Working Paper No. 995, 2023

Abstract: We study how firms respond to an unexpected cash-flow shock and whether financial constraints shape that response, using the behavior of Chilean firms during the 2019 social unrest. More exposed firms experience larger declines in sales, larger employment losses and more missed financial payments, and these responses are significantly stronger for firms more likely to be financially

constrained. Constrained firms pass almost half of their sales decline on to labor and input demand, more than twice the rate of unconstrained firms.

"Telling Schools Apart: The Role of Preferences, Constraints, and the Ability to Differentiate Between Schools in Parents' Choices" with Diego Amador and Nicolás Grau. SSRN Working Paper, 2020

Papers in Progress

"Data Centers" with Jonas Hjort and Ana Cepeda

Summary: How new data centers across Africa change the time data takes to travel between places, and how faster connections affect firms and local economic activity.

"Internet Providers and Political Regimes" with Jonas Hjort and Emilio Guaman

Summary: Governments with lower state capacity may control the internet through its providers, for example by licensing them in exchange for the power to shut the network down. We study whether internet providers sort across political regimes in Africa, and how this shapes where and how well the internet reaches people.

Policy Reports

"Economic Groups as a Unit of Analysis for Financial Stability" with Patricio Toro. Box IV.2, Financial Stability Report, 2019:H2, Central Bank of Chile

"Predictive Models of Default and Recovery of Corporate Loans" with Enzo Cerletti, J. Fernández, and A. Vásquez. Background note, Financial Stability Report, 2019:H2, Central Bank of Chile

Seminars and Conferences

EEA–ESEM Annual Congress, Dublin; SIOE Annual Conference, INSEAD; Queen Mary PhD Economics Conference; Queen Mary Economics Seminar 2026

IWAEE; LACEA Annual Meeting; SECHI Annual Meeting; Queen Mary seminars 2018–25

Fellowships & Awards

ANID Doctoral Scholarship, Government of Chile 2021

PhD Scholarship, Queen Mary University of London 2021

COES Scholarship (project quality), Chile 2017

Best in Business Award & Grunwald Scholarship, University of Chile 2016

Circle of Excellence (top 5% of cohort), University of Chile 2013–15

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Queen Mary University of London

Quantitative Methods using R (×4); Health Economics; Macroeconomics I 2023–26

Instructor, Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez

Econometrics I (×2) — designed syllabus, lectures, and assessment 2016–17

Teaching Assistant, University of Chile

Industrial Organization; Econometrics I; Econometrics II; Applied Econometrics 2013–17

Research Experience

Visiting Researcher, University of Oslo (host: Jonas Hjort) 2026

Research Assistant, Jonas Hjort, University College London 2022–25

Research Assistant, Pedro C. L. Souza, Queen Mary University of London 2022

Research Assistant, Kirill Borusyak, University College London 2021

Research Analyst, Micro-Finance Research Unit, Central Bank of Chile 2018–21

Research Assistant, William Mullins, UC San Diego 2018–19

Research Assistant, V. Paredes, F. Duarte, F. Pino & A. Micco, University of Chile 2015–18

Skills

Programming: R, Stata/Mata, Python, SQL, MATLAB, QGIS, LaTeX

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)